Backup and Disaster Recovery Procedures

Organization: Meridian Technologies

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Department: IT and Security

Team: Infrastructure

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1. Purpose

This document defines the backup and disaster recovery procedures used to protect Meridian Technologies' business applications, databases and organizational information.

The Infrastructure team is responsible for maintaining backup schedules, validating recovery processes and coordinating disaster recovery activities.

2. Backup Strategy

Meridian maintains regular backups of critical application and database systems.

The backup strategy includes:

- Daily incremental backups.
- Weekly full backups.
- Monthly archival snapshots.
- Periodic backup integrity verification.

Critical databases must receive daily backups.

Backup copies must be stored separately from the primary production environment to reduce the risk of simultaneous data loss.

3. Backup Schedule

System	Backup Frequency	Retention
PostgreSQL	Daily	90 days

databases		
Application configuration	Daily	30 days
Object storage metadata	Daily	90 days
Infrastructure configuration	Weekly	90 days
Full system snapshots	Monthly	12 months

Backup retention must also follow IT-003 where applicable.

4. Recovery Objectives

The following recovery objectives apply to critical services:

Metric	Target
Recovery Time Objective (RTO)	4 hours
Recovery Point Objective (RPO)	1 hour

Backup verification	Weekly
Recovery simulation	Quarterly

RTO represents the target time required to restore service.

RPO represents the maximum targeted amount of data loss measured in time.

These targets are internal planning objectives rather than guarantees.

5. Disaster Recovery Triggers

Disaster recovery procedures may be activated in situations involving:

- Major infrastructure failure.
- Database corruption.
- Storage system unavailability.
- Ransomware or destructive security incidents.
- Regional infrastructure outages.
- Accidental deletion of critical organizational data.

The Infrastructure Manager coordinates the recovery process.

6. Recovery Procedure

The standard recovery process consists of:

1. Identify the affected system and determine the failure scope.
2. Notify the Infrastructure Manager.
3. Isolate affected infrastructure where necessary.
4. Identify the most recent verified backup.
5. Restore the required database or application data.
6. Validate restored data integrity.
7. Restart dependent services.
8. Verify application availability.
9. Document recovery results.

Backend Engineering must assist when application-level validation or database compatibility checks are required.

7. Recovery Testing

The Infrastructure team must conduct quarterly recovery simulations.

Each simulation must record:

- Test date.
- System tested.
- Backup version.
- Recovery duration.
- Data integrity result.
- Identified problems.
- Corrective actions.

A failed recovery test must be investigated and repeated after corrective measures are implemented.

8. Security Requirements

Backup files must be protected against unauthorized access and modification.

Encryption must be used for sensitive backup data.

Access to backup infrastructure is limited to authorized Infrastructure personnel.

Backup credentials must not be included in source code or application logs.

9. Responsibilities

Role	Responsibility
Infrastructure Manager	Owns recovery procedures
Infrastructure Engineer	Executes backups and restoration

Backend Engineering	Validates application and database recovery
Cybersecurity	Investigates security-related data loss
Department Heads	Confirm business service priorities

10. Related Documents

- IT-001: Enterprise Access Control Policy
- IT-003: Data Retention and Disposal Policy
- IT-005: Security Incident Handling Playbook
- ENG-004: Production Deployment and Incident Response

11. Version History

Version	Date	Description
1.0	2026-04-10	Initial backup and recovery procedure

Document Owner: Infrastructure Manager